Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Pentre House

Pentre House, Pentre Road, Pentre, CF41 7DJ

01443 441929

The inspection visit took place on 16/07/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	Rhondda Cynon Taff County Borough Council Adults and Children's Services
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care, Provision for learning disability, Provision for mental health
Registered places:	29
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider makes an effort to promote the use of the Welsh language and culture or is working towards a bilingual service.

Ratings:

Well-being	Excellent
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Excellent
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

Pentre House is a Local Authority residential home providing care and support to older adults with residential care needs. It is located centrally within Pentre.

Well-being is excellent because people are supported to live meaningful, independent and fulfilling lives. People are at the centre of decisions about their care and support. They benefit from strong relationships with care staff who know them well and promote their rights, strengths and aspirations. Care and support is good because people receive personalised, outcome-focused care which reflects their needs, preferences and wishes. Detailed care planning, effective multidisciplinary working and strong safeguarding arrangements support people to remain safe and healthy. The environment is excellent because people live in an exceptionally welcoming, comfortable and homely setting which enhances their quality of life. Leadership and management is good because strong, values-led leadership, and good governance and quality assurance systems support positive outcomes for people. Managers demonstrate a strong commitment to continuous improvement and actively involve people and care staff in the development of the service. A stable, skilled and well-supported staff team provides consistent care and contributes to a positive culture throughout the home.

Findings:

Well-being — Excellent

Well-being is excellent because people are supported to live healthy, safe and meaningful lives with high levels of choice, control and independence. People are at the centre of care planning and are encouraged to make decisions about their daily routines, activities, visitors and how they spend their time. Care staff consistently treat people with dignity, kindness and respect and promote their rights, strengths and aspirations. Positive risk-taking is managed extremely well, helping people maintain independence while remaining safe. Resident meetings and surveys provide meaningful opportunities to influence the service, and advocacy is arranged proactively when required. People benefit from varied activities, strong community links and excellent access to healthcare professionals, supporting their physical, mental and emotional well-being. Care staff understand people's communication needs and work closely with families and professionals to achieve positive outcomes. The service demonstrates an excellent commitment to promoting Welsh language and culture and is making strong progress towards the Active Offer. We observed a warm and positive atmosphere where people appeared relaxed, engaged and happy. People told us *"It's brilliant here…I feel safe. I've got everything I need - what more could I ask for"* and *"Can't fault them. It's lovely and clean…my family are so pleased I'm here*". Families and visiting professionals told us *"The staff go above and beyond for residents, organising a variety of activities and outings", "Staff are friendly and caring, nothing is too much",* and *"it's a warm, professional and supportive service that places the needs and wellbeing of residents at the centre of everything it does"*.

Safeguarding is embedded throughout the service. Effective systems identify risks at an early stage and support vulnerable people to remain safe. Strong partnerships with external professionals help ensure concerns are managed appropriately and promptly. Information about safeguarding, complaints and raising concerns is readily available, and people remain involved in decisions affecting their safety and well-being. Management oversight is robust and there is clear evidence of learning from incidents and safeguarding events to strengthen practice.

People's well-being is greatly enhanced because individuality, identity and personal history are valued and respected. Equality, diversity and inclusion are actively promoted, including creative initiatives which encourage people to learn about and celebrate different cultures. People maintain important relationships with family and friends in an exceptionally warm and welcoming environment. Positive risk management supports inclusion rather than restricting opportunities, helping people remain active and involved in their communities. Strong peer relationships contribute to a friendly and socially active atmosphere.

People live in accommodation which supports their well-being outcomes exceptionally well. The home is highly personalised, welcoming and maintained to a very high standard. Investment and refurbishment are continually ongoing and completed to an outstanding standard. Bedrooms reflect people's preferences and promote a strong sense of ownership and belonging. Equipment and adaptations support safety, comfort and independence throughout the home. People are consulted about environmental improvements, ensuring developments reflect their wishes and enhance their quality of life. The home is safe, clean, comfortable and accessible, with access to outdoor spaces and opportunities to enjoy the wider community.

Care & Support — Good

Care and support is good because people receive consistent, person-centred care which meets their needs, promotes their independence and supports positive outcomes. Care plans are comprehensive, detailed and developed with people, reflecting their strengths, preferences and outcomes. Plans provide clear guidance for care staff and are reviewed regularly to ensure they remain accurate. Detailed risk assessments support safe care while promoting independence. We observed warm and respectful interactions between care staff and people, with a relaxed and homely atmosphere throughout the home. Care staff know people well and provide support in line with their wishes and preferences. Mealtimes are enjoyable, unhurried and offer choice.

People are protected from harm because safeguarding arrangements are well established. Care staff understand their safeguarding responsibilities and reporting procedures. Management works effectively with partner agencies to safeguard people and takes prompt action to reduce identified risks. Incidents, accidents and safeguarding concerns are reviewed to identify learning and improve practice. Management promotes an open and transparent culture and responds appropriately when concerns are raised. Deprivation of Liberty Safeguards (DoLS) arrangements are managed appropriately, best interest processes are followed, and advocacy is considered whenever needed. Consent and mental capacity issues are managed well, helping people remain involved in decisions about their care and support.

Systems are in place to support the administration, storage and monitoring of medication. The service maintains strong links with district nurses, advanced practitioners and pharmacy services to support people's health needs. Medication administration records are accurate and reflect prescribed medicines. Care staff receive medication training and competency assessments to ensure they remain knowledgeable and competent. The medication room is secure, clean and well organised. Controlled drug storage and recording systems are good, and clear arrangements ensure medication changes are communicated promptly to relevant care staff. Management demonstrates a positive approach to learning from any issues. Regular audits help ensure correct medication stocks and help identify opportunities for further improvement.

The service maintains good infection prevention and control practices. We found the home to be very clean throughout, and laundry and clinical waste arrangements were generally managed appropriately. Care staff have access to suitable supplies and equipment to support safe practice. Effective auditing and monitoring arrangements help ensure standards remain consistent. The service has a transparent approach to reporting concerns and uses oversight processes to identify issues.

Environment — Excellent

The environment is excellent because people benefit from an exceptionally high-quality home which enhances their well-being, promotes independence and provides a comfortable, welcoming place to live. The environment is a significant strength of the service. Recently refurbished areas have been completed to an outstanding standard and go beyond what would be expected. Improvements demonstrate creativity, innovation and a genuine commitment and passion to improving people's quality of life with the resources available. Management actively involves people in decisions about improvements, ensuring developments reflect their preferences and wishes. The service is developing a dedicated facility to support people with their end-of-life journey, following collaborative work with health professionals. This demonstrates a proactive and compassionate approach to supporting people and their families at an important stage of life.

The environment meets people's needs extremely well and supports positive outcomes. Lifts, stair lifts and appropriate adaptations help people move around the home safely and independently. Bedrooms are personalised to reflect individual tastes and preferences, promoting a strong sense of ownership and belonging. People have a choice of several attractive and welcoming communal areas where they can socialise, relax or take part in activities. Private spaces are available for visitors and confidential conversations, supporting people's privacy and dignity. Outdoor areas are easily accessible and were being used by people during our visit. The overall design of the home creates a warm, inclusive and homely atmosphere where people appear comfortable and at ease.

The service is clean, free from clutter and maintained to a high standard. Bathroom and toilet facilities are creatively decorated, being sufficient to meet people's needs and promote dignity and independence. Temperature, lighting and comfort levels throughout the home are appropriate and contribute positively to people's well-being. Effective maintenance arrangements ensure repairs are completed promptly and the environment remains safe and welcoming. We found health and safety files, maintenance records and servicing documentation are well organised and up to date. Personal emergency evacuation plans and emergency arrangements are managed appropriately, helping ensure people remain safe. The continued investment and commitment to improving the environment help people achieve excellent outcomes and enjoy a high quality of life.

Leadership & Management — Good

Leadership and management is good because people benefit from strong leadership, effective oversight and a positive values-led culture which supports people's outcomes. The management team has a strong understanding of the service and the people living there, demonstrating a clear commitment to providing high-quality, person-centred care. We received very positive feedback about the manager and deputy manager, who are visible, approachable and knowledgeable. Care staff told us *"They are approachable, they are always willing to help staff, even if it is last minute, very family orientated, they are visible and don't just sit in the office all day,"* and *"Pentre House has been going from strength to strength and this is due to the management. They really care about staff and individuals alike."* Effective governance arrangements are in place, including regular quality of care reviews by the Responsible Individual and detailed oversight visits to consult with people and staff. An audit programme covers key areas such as medication, care planning, health and safety, infection control, fire safety, and the environment. The management team complete regular monitoring checks and use findings to identify improvements and drive development. People are involved in shaping the service through resident meetings and surveys, with feedback influencing activities, trips, decoration and refurbishment projects. Effective communication systems support continuity of care, and incidents, accidents and medication errors are reviewed to promote learning and improve practice. The service actively promotes learning through staff champion roles, additional training opportunities, and regular staff meetings where lessons learned and service developments are discussed.

People are supported by a stable, skilled and well-trained staff team. Training compliance is good overall, with learning opportunities reflecting the needs of people using the service, such as falls training, manual handling and safeguarding. Care staff have access to additional development opportunities beyond mandatory training, and all are registered with Social Care Wales.
Supervision, appraisal and induction arrangements are well established and support care staff to develop their knowledge and skills. Recruitment records generally demonstrate safe recruitment practices. Staffing levels observed during the inspection appeared to meet people's needs, with support being calm and unhurried. A large pool of bank staff means agency staff do not need to be used, helping provide continuity of care. Feedback from care staff was overwhelmingly positive regarding leadership, support and opportunities for professional development, contributing to a motivated workforce. Feedback included "*I love it here…we all work together well…the staff team is fab", "I feel well trained and feel able to go on more training… they always offer training to us when opportunities come up",* and *"Pentre House is a lovely home. The care and support provided to all residents is phenomenal. There is so much thought and passion that goes into constantly updating and improving the home to ensure residents feel like they are at home".*

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

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